KAREN KODERA
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WORK EXPERIENCE

Kroger – Product Designer
May 2025 - now | Remote
- Designing customer-facing mobile and web experiences, serving 11 million online grocery shoppers daily
- Partnering with PMs and engineers for new initiatives including redesign efforts and HSA/FSA integration
- Contributing to accessibility improvements in high-traffic purchase journeys
- Reviewing and desk-checking engineering builds to ensure quality prior to release

Kroger – Product Design Intern
Jun 2024 - Aug 2024 | Chicago, IL
- Implemented Offline Mode in e-comm POS app to eliminate all paper usage in delivery driver experience
- Facilitated ideation workshops leading team through design exercises
- Conducted user surveys and field research to diagnose paper usage as largest obstacle to employee productivity

Northwestern University – Graduate Teaching Assistant
Jan 2023 – Mar 2025 | Evanston, IL
- Supported instruction for graduate-level courses in product design, design strategy, and human-centered innovation

DICK's Sporting Goods - Product Design Intern
Jun 2023 - Dec 2023 | Pittsburgh, PA
- Designed a new system for auditing online orders in fulfillment cutting existing process time in half
- Built in haptic feedback to combat issues with RFID sled battery for inventory scanning in-store
- Executed interviews with users and stakeholders, in-store field research, and in-store usability testing in 10+ stores

PROJECT EXPERIENCE

The Garage - Founder in Residence
Jan 2024 – Mar 2025 | Chicago, IL
- Founded KiT, a social connection app for long distance communication, owning product strategy, UX and prototyping from concept to MVP
- Secured funding from Northwestern's entrepreneurship hub, the Garage
- Defined product vision and prioritized features in an ambiguous, early-stage problem space

Northwestern Medicine – Product Designer
Jan 2024 - Jun 2024 | Evanston, IL | Sponsored project for Northwestern University
- Put together an in-patient service for nurses to more efficiently deliver call buttons to the bedside of patients with mobility disabilities
- Developed educational tool COAST (Chronic Opioid Use Assessment and Screening Tool) for Young Adults with IBD
- Organized and ran hospital visits, patient and doctor conversations to solution package lockers to fix delivery issues

Proctor & Gamble – Product Designer for Gillette (Under NDA)
Sept 2023 - Dec 2023 | Evanston, IL | Sponsored project for Northwestern University
- Conducted ethnographic user research and tested prototypes with consumers
- Synthesized quantitative user data to identify needs and develop a physical product solution

EDUCATION

Northwestern University – M.S. Engineering Design Innovation (Focus: UI/UX, Design Strategy)
Sept 2023 - Mar 2025 | GPA: 3.92/4.0

Georgia Institute of Technology – B.S. Architecture (Minors: Psychology and Japanese)
Aug 2018 - Aug 2023 | GPA: 3.89/4.0

SKILLS

- **Tools:** Figma, AI-Assisted Prototyping, Dscout, Miro/Mural, Jira, UserZoom, Dovetail, Qualtrics, Rhino, Photoshop, Framer
- **Design:** Product Thinking, User Research, Usability Testing, UI/UX Design, Rapid Prototyping, Visual Storytelling, Data Visualization, Design Strategy, Workshop Facilitation, Interaction Design, Service Design, Accessibility Design